

Company Overview

Performance Drone Works (PDW) builds technologies for the warfighter, by the warfighter. Born out of the Drone Racing League, our roots are competitive, our mindset is tactical, and our mission is clear: deliver purpose-built unmanned systems to those who serve. We are not here to sell vapor; we build and ship real capabilities for real missions.

Now, we're entering a new phase of growth and are looking for a Senior Director of Mission Support that will be responsible for leading a global mission support team to ensure operational readiness, sustainment, and effective deployment of unmanned aerial systems in support of defense, law enforcement, and customer operations worldwide. This role oversees all aspects of technical support, maintenance strategy, and field operations. It is responsible for sustainment logistics, driving performance, standardization, and mission success across multiple theaters of operation.

What You'll Do

- Define and execute the global mission support strategy to ensure operational readiness and rapid response capability for PDW's UAS products and associated mission-critical systems.
- Establish performance standards, policies, and best practices that align with DoD, Law Enforcement, and Partner requirements.
- Drive innovation in support operations by implementing emerging technologies, predictive maintenance programs, and data-driven performance monitoring.
- Oversee all maintenance, diagnostics, and sustainment operations for PDW's platforms across global deployment sites.
- Lead regional and forward-deployed mission support personnel, ensuring consistent execution of preventative maintenance, troubleshooting, and system validation procedures.
- Direct rapid-response capabilities to support urgent mission requirements, both CONUS and OCONUS.
- Responsible for the design, development, and execution of PDW internal and external GTM training and enablement programs. Eliminate single points of failure within the organization by cross-training and scaling internal capabilities.
- Provide oversight to ensure customers, support personnel, and partners maintain the highest levels of technical proficiency.
- Ensure global training strategies are aligned with PDW's objectives and regulatory requirements.
- Monitor training effectiveness through performance metrics, readiness assessments, and operational feedback from the field.

- Develop leadership succession plans and professional development programs to ensure organizational resilience.
- Collaborate with engineering, manufacturing, logistics, and Customer Success teams to improve product reliability, supportability, and sustainment workflows.
- Collaborate with Sales Leadership to better liaison with military program offices, partners, and senior leadership on all matters related to mission support readiness.
- Coordinate with supply chain and logistics leadership to ensure timely availability of spare parts, tools, and specialized equipment.
- Maintain compliance with DoD, FAA, ITAR, and Partner regulatory requirements across all mission support activities.
- Lead root cause analysis and implement corrective action plans to address systemic performance issues.

Requirements

- Bachelor's degree in engineering, aviation, logistics, or related field is preferable; Master's degree is a bonus.
- 10+ years of experience in mission support, sustainment operations, or related fields, with at least 5 years in senior leadership roles.
- Proven track record leading global or multi-regional technical support organizations, preferably within defense, aerospace, or UAS sectors.
- Strong understanding of UAS platforms and payloads (fixed-wing, multirotor, hybrid), electronics, and integrated software architectures.
- Expertise in executing global sustainment strategies, including preventative and predictive maintenance programs.
- Demonstrated ability to lead dispersed teams in high-tempo, mission-critical environments.
- Exceptional stakeholder management skills with the ability to engage senior military and government leaders.
- Strong analytical and problem-solving skills with the ability to make decisions under pressure.
- Ability to travel internationally as required.
- Ability to obtain security clearance.

Physical Requirements

The physical demands described here are representative of those that must be met to successfully perform the essential functions of the job. Ability to sit, stand, bend, reach, and move about regularly throughout the day and lift/carry up to 50 pounds. Must have

manual dexterity to operate standard office equipment such as computers, printers, and phones. Must be physically capable of walking between the office and production areas and attending events or meetings off-site as needed.

Work Environment

This position typically operates in an office setting and manufacturing environment. This role requires use of standard office equipment and will require occasional travel to customer locations or facilities. This position may have exposure to outdoor weather conditions, noise, and non-climate-controlled environments. May require the use of personal protective equipment (PPE) depending on the environment. This is a fast-paced work environment and requires cross departmental collaboration with independent and team-based responsibilities.

ITAR Requirement

In compliance with International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR), candidates must be U.S. Citizens, U.S. Permanent Residents (Green Card holders), or individuals granted asylee/refugee status as defined by 8 U.S.C. 1324b(a)(3).

Compensation and Benefits

PDW values our team, and we offer a compensation package reflective of your experience and capabilities. Benefits include:

- Comprehensive BCBS medical, dental, and vision coverage; 80% sponsored by the company
- Safe Harbor 401(K) with company match
- Paid Parental Leave
- A work environment that encourages teamwork and innovation
- Competitive salary, generous paid time off (PTO), and flexible leave options
- On-site fitness center.

EEO Statement

PDW is an equal opportunity employer that upholds all federal and state non-discrimination laws. We ensure a fair and unbiased evaluation for employment for all qualified candidates regardless of race, color, religion, age, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, marital status, medical condition, disability, genetic information, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by law.